

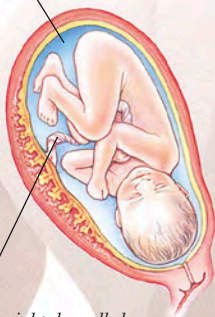


An ear to touch

After 19 weeks the baby, or fetus, is properly formed, but it could not yet live outside the mother's body. It is growing very fast and is moving around a lot inside the mother.

The baby grows inside a warm, safe bag which is full of watery liquid. There is not much room so it curls up.

Nutrients and oxygen travel from the mother to the baby through a mass of blood vessels, called the placenta.



A special tube, called the umbilical cord, links the placenta to the baby's tummy.

After forty weeks the baby is ready to be born. When a mother is having her baby it is called labor because it is very hard work.

The baby usually comes out head first. The muscles of the uterus help to push it out.

